

## STARTER

# Common Rejection Reasons & How to Avoid Them

United States - Tourist Visa (B-2)

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Almost every B-2 refusal comes down to one legal standard, not a checklist of paperwork mistakes. Understanding it changes how you should prepare.

## The starting presumption: INA Section 214(b)

U.S. law presumes every temporary visa applicant intends to immigrate permanently, unless the applicant proves otherwise. This is why the interview isn't really about your travel plans in isolation - it's about whether the officer believes you have strong enough reasons to return home. A refusal under 214(b) is the single most common outcome for weak applications, and it is not a permanent bar: you can reapply at any time once your circumstances genuinely support a stronger case.

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## The most common specific reasons

### 1. Weak or unclear ties to your home country

"Ties" means the job, family, property, or obligations that would make it costly for you to abandon your home country - the things that pull you back. Officers look for concrete, specific ties, not general statements.

**How to avoid it:**

- Bring documentation of your job (letter, pay stubs), property, or family obligations
- Be specific in interview answers - a named employer and a return-to-work date carries more weight than "I have a job"
- Younger applicants with fewer traditional ties should lean on other anchors: enrolled studies, a family business, or documented plans that clearly require your return

### 2. Vague or inconsistent travel plans

**How to avoid it:**

- Be able to describe, in one or two sentences, where you're going and roughly for how long
- Make sure your DS-160 answers and interview answers tell the same story
- You don't need every booking finalized, but you should sound like someone who has actually thought about the trip

### 3. Unclear or insufficient financial evidence

**How to avoid it:**

- Bring evidence that covers the real cost of your trip, not just a token balance
- A large, unexplained lump-sum deposit shortly before applying often raises more questions than it answers
  - build up funds naturally where possible
- See the Financial Requirements Overview (included in the Essential tier and above) for detail

## 4. Prior immigration violations

### How to avoid it:

- Disclose any prior overstay, unauthorized work, or violation honestly on the DS-160
- Be ready to explain what happened and what's different now
- A past issue doesn't automatically mean refusal, but hiding it almost always does

## 5. Inconsistencies between the DS-160 and the interview

### How to avoid it:

- Keep a copy of your submitted DS-160 and re-read it before your interview
- If something has changed since you filed it (new job, new travel dates), be ready to explain the change rather than let it look like a contradiction

## 6. A previous refusal that wasn't meaningfully addressed

### How to avoid it:

- Reapplying with the identical case rarely changes the outcome
- Be ready to explain, briefly, what's different since your last application
- See the Visa Refusal Decision Guide (included in the Premium tier) for a full walkthrough

### **221(g) is not a refusal**

If your case is placed in administrative processing (a “221(g)” notice) rather than refused, that's a temporary status while the post gathers more information or you supply an additional document - it's a pause, not a denial, and resolves on its own timeline.